



Canadian Culture & Newcomers Culture

The Similarities and Contrasts

By Farida Rezaie

What is Culture it self:

- 
- Culture generally indicates to the way people live their life.
 - OR can say it is set of believes and life structure practiced and passed down from generation to generation
 - It also includes art, codes of manners, dress, language, religion, rituals, social behaviors and so on.



Variety of beautiful cultures
around the globe that in one
hand
DIFFERENTIATES people
and in the other
ATTRACTS people to be
connected



Culture and its Importance

- ❑ I chose this topic because I find it is very important in our day to day life in a new country
- ❑ Knowing what culture is and how diverse it is, helps Canadians and newcomers connect much easier
- ❑ The impact of knowing similarities and differences of cultures is to create a better sense of understanding
- ❑ Knowing each different culture attracts you to the beauties they have and motivates to connect more with people
- ❑ Knowing about cultures help newcomers settle easily and helps hosting people welcome warmly

Canadian Cultures:

- Even that Canada is known as a multicultural country but still lets start talking about the very first peoples culture in this land.
- Indigenous, Anglophone and Francophone all are known to be fair, polite, inclusive and tolerant



- In its broadest sense, Canadian culture is a mixture of British, French, and American influences, all of which blend and sometimes compete in every aspect of cultural life, from filmmaking and writing to cooking and playing sports.



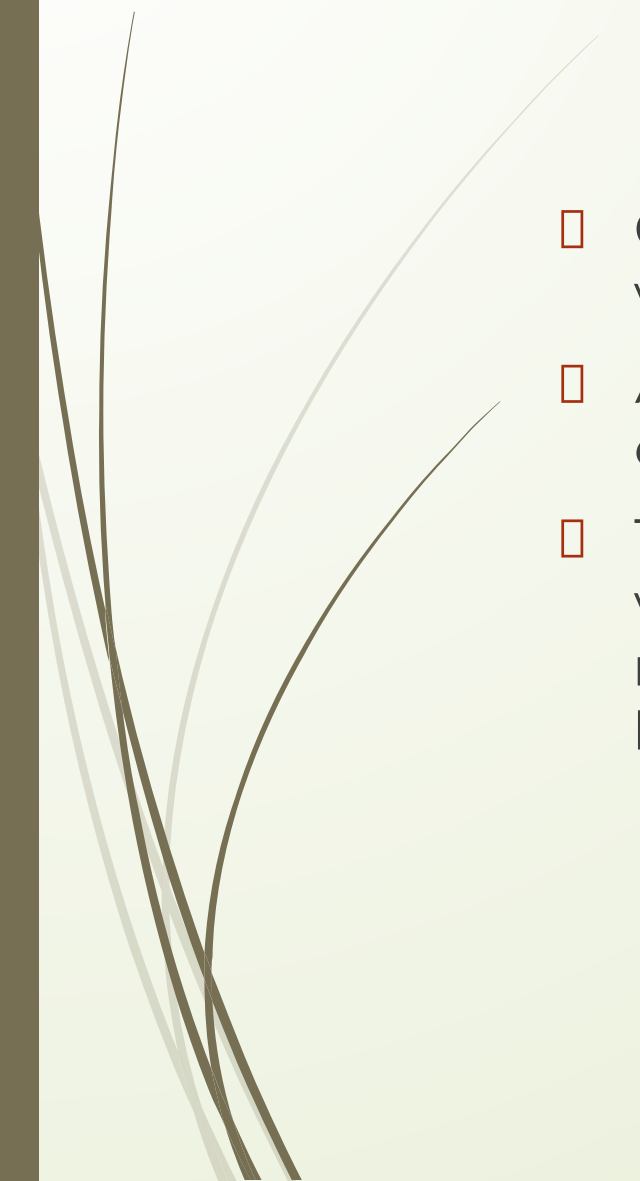
Modern Canada

- ❑ In 1971 Canada became the first country in the world to adopt a multiculturalism policy
- ❑ Canada combines 450 different cultural origins reported by Statistics Canada
- ❑ European (52.5%), North American (22.9%), Asian (19.3%), North American Indigenous (6.1%), African (3.8%), Latin, Central and South American (2.5%), Caribbean (2.1%), Oceanian (0.3%), and Other (6%)





Similarities and Differences

- ❑ Canadian culture known as western culture has a lot in common with American, European and Australian culture
 - ❑ African and Asian culture comes to be much different from western cultures
 - ❑ To dig deeper, there are developing countries like Afghanistan which are having much more gaps with the modern world that makes differences higher than similarities where as the result it becomes a challenge for newcomers to settle in
- 



Canadian vs Afghan Culture (Differences)

- 
- ❑ A handshake is a common greeting between strangers
 - ❑ Canadians are more open and frank
 - ❑ Canadians are more individualistic
 - ❑ "Please" & "Sorry" are used more commonly among Canadians
 - ❑ It's normal to call someone by the first name like "Ali"
 - ❑ A handshake is common greeting when both sides are same gender
 - ❑ Afghans are more reserved and conservative
 - ❑ While Afghans are so family oriented or collectivistic
 - ❑ Afghans use "Please" when tend to be polite. It's ok not to say please in daily informal communications
 - ❑ It's normal to call by the last name plus adding a title "Mr.Ahmadi"

Canadian vs Afghan Culture



Community engagement:

We went to one of the CCI event that taught us how to skate, and in that event as we see on the picture, the people engaged with each others.

I was volunteer and there were different people from different countries had came to the event. The people in the community come together and get involved in the skating activities and it is, helps Canadians and newcomers connect much easier



Community Engagement:

Some more pictures:



Community Carnival:

I went to a community carnival as a volunteer. There were different people from different countries had came to the carnival, and there were different kinds of games , rides, food, and entertainment for people of all ages.

In the community carnival, both canadian and newcomers engaged with each other in various ways. it was a fantastic opportunity for them, as I saw some newcomers and Canadian were exchanged their experiences, customs, traditions food...which can be a great way to learn and appreciate different cultures and also its help for building connections and it is a beautiful melting pot of diversity and togetherness. On other hand, Canadian welcomed newcomers at the carnival community and shared their experiences, and help them feel more comfortable at their new home



Community Carnival:



Community Carnival:



Ethiopian vs Vietnamese Culture (Similarities)

- **“Greeting”** is very important, you can’t skip! Elders first and you have to take their hands
- **“Family”** is their first priority that family’s interest come first
- **“Saying NO”** is not polite so they tend to say NO indirectly in a polite way
- **“Age”** an elderly person is always right and you never try to argue them or disrespect their idea
- **“Greeting”** is a must and is to be done considering the age, take hands with both hands or bow
- **“Family”** is the most aspect of their life where family interest is always first
- **“NO”** is rude so polite way is to give hints to mean you are refusing something
- **“Age”** never get offended when an elderly comments you or ask you any type of questions



Conclusion



- The more we know about different people, the more confident we become to connect
- Knowing our differences and similarities help to find better ways to connect
- Let's talk about our culture, our values, interests and sensitivities to know more about each other
- The diverse we are the beautiful we look
- The more we connect, the strong and united we become



Thank You!

References

- <https://culturalatlas.sbs.com.au/countries>
- <https://www.thecanadianencyclopedia.ca/en/article/multiculturalism>
- <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Canadians>